

if you are not directly connected. Under the Downloads link, the location to save downloaded files to can be set. The maximum number of simultaneous connections can be specified here. Public Hub lists are lists of DC hubs addresses available from different online sites. It is best not to modify this, unless you have achieved some level of expertise (in which case you wouldn't be reading this!). Under the Queue settings, the client can be configured to automatically prioritise / de-prioritise files based on size; similarly, sources of data can be dropped if they do not meet specified criteria. Under Sharing, you can specify the folder that can be accessible to other peers.

Since many hubs limit peers without a minimum shared data size, it is recommended to ensure that an empty folder is not being shared. Once a folder is shared, its contents are scanned and hash values prepared. Depending on the size of files shared, this process can be lengthy, and so you can relegate the hashing process to the background. Files will not be shared before they are hashed.

The number of upload slots can be specified here. Under the Appearance link, the visual aspects of the bland interface can be spruced up—just a bit. The Advanced link offers additional tweaking options. The option to “Register with windows to handle magnet:URI links” will ensure that clicking on such a link will launch DC++.

4.8.4 Comments

DC++ offers a lean interface that is similar to that of μ Torrent in many ways. Since no other client (except for Strong DC++, which is very similar) supports the Direct Connect protocol, you are left with a Hobson's choice!

4.9 Conclusion

Every network has its advantages and disadvantages. While BitTorrent is the fastest way to get the latest content, the other networks offer greater interaction between peers. Data retention is the poorest in BT while it is possible to find the most arcane stuff in the niche hubs in DC networks. You just need to know where to look.